

Grammar of Agency

This Glossary is the Rosetta Stone for the Grammar of Agency: it defines the core terms in a phenomenological way, in the moment of moral act, providing operators with a shared vocabulary for navigating those moral moments of act with clarity and integrity. CST/JPP lets operators navigate the ship in a chaotic world.

Glossary of CST/JPP Terms

Con + facere

To make with, the moral moment is formed by not only the moral **Agent**, but by **Influencer(s)** (field), and by the **Witness**, who may or may not have a duty to testify, depending.

Agent

The human moral actor who performs *actus*.

Carries the vertical axis (faith, hope, love) and is solely responsible for action unless autonomy is overridden.

Influencer

Any force — person, system, structure, or context — that shapes the field in which the Agent acts.

Influences clarity, stability, and proportion but does not act in the **Agent's** place.

Witness

The tertiary evaluator who reads the **moral vector** of the moment.

The **Witness** testifies **only** when systemic disturbance threatens the **Agent's** autonomy.

If autonomy is intact, the **Witness** remains silent.

Moral Vector

The directional force created when the **Agent** acts within a field shaped by the Influencer and observed by the **Witness**.

Evaluated for **integrity**, not for judging the **Agent**.

Witness Moment

The instant of *actus* when the Agent **penetrates the horizontal plane** and the vertical axis enters the world.

This is where the “wind hits the sail” — the spirit animates the action.

The moment where action becomes testimony.

Actus

The decisive, embodied action taken by the **Agent**.

The hinge between intention and consequence.

The only moment where agency is real.

CST Fourfold Test

The altitude instrument that reveals what the moment is asking.

A moment is evaluated by whether the contemplated action:

1. Restores human dignity
2. Seeds the common good
3. Strengthens sisterhood/brotherhood
4. Uplifts the little ones

This is the **operator’s manual for moments**.

JPP (Judgment-Premised Processing)

The steering mechanism — a kata for navigating chaotic moments with clarity and proportion.

Not a system for judging people.

A discipline for **prudential praxis**.

Prudential Praxis

Acting with direction, mindfulness, and purpose in the moment.

Prudence operationalized as movement, not theory.

Horizontal Plane (Virtue Matrix)

The stabilizing field of the four cardinal virtues:

- Prudence
- Justice
- Fortitude
- Temperance

This plane is **computationally legible** — an LLM can evaluate balance, proportion, and distortion.

Vertical Axis (Transcendent Spine)

The human-only virtues:

- Faith
- Hope
- Love

These cannot be computed or automated.

They orient the Agent toward meaning, purpose, and moral depth.

Keel

The grounding structure that keeps the **Agent** upright in turbulent conditions.
Symbolizes the vertical virtues anchoring the craft.

Sail

The receptive surface that catches the **Wind** (spirit).
Represents the **Agent's** openness to meaning, purpose, and transcendent orientation.

Wind

The animating forces the spirit, *ruah*, breath — that cannot be diagrammed.
Reveals itself only in the **Witness Moment** when it hits the sail.

Yoke / Harness

The constraint that preserves agency without domination.
Keeps the **Agent** centered and prevents drift.

Stabilizers

The balancing structures that prevent roll, pitch, and distortion.

Horizontal stabilizers = cardinal virtues Prudence, Temperance, Justice, Fortitude

Vertical stabilizers = transcendent virtues Faith, Hope, Love

Wu Wei Timing Belt

The discipline of restraint.

Knowing when **not** to act, when to let the tea steep, when to allow the field to settle.

A core part of prudential praxis.

Mantra: Let the tea steep. Gather seeds. Scent tea. Palm seeds. Breathe. Ground.

Four Moves (Operator Sequence)

1. **Frame - take in the moment, self-awareness, field awareness, snapped in**
2. **Receive + Sense - actively passive**
3. **Orient + Align - framing with purpose and direction**
4. **Act + Integrate - now, in this moment, *act*. Assess, iterate. Stability provides closure: clean, no ripple left.**

The repeatable kata that forms disposition through praxis.

Systemic Disturbance

Any distortion in the field that threatens the **Agent's** autonomy:

coercion, manipulation, deception, structural injustice, emotional overwhelm, power imbalance.

Only under these conditions does the **Witness** testify.

TENSEGRITY

Definition:

A structural principle in which stability emerges from the dynamic balance of tension and compression elements. In the Grammar of Agency, tensegrity describes how the instrument holds its shape under load: the keel, yoke, and stabilizers provide compression; the timing belt, drift-correction, and witness moment provide tension; and the wind animates the whole system. The architecture remains upright not through rigidity but through balanced forces.

Function:

Tensegrity explains why the system does not collapse when stressed. Each component counterbalances the others, allowing the operator to maintain orientation, agency, and moral clarity even in chaotic conditions. It is the underlying physics that makes drift, wobble, recovery arcs, and stabilizers coherent.

Operator's Note:

Tensegrity is a late-unlock concept. It becomes visible only once the full instrument is assembled and in motion. It names the felt experience of a system that is stable because it is alive, not because it is fixed.